

Module 1 Glossary Terms

Cybersecurity (or security)

The practice of ensuring the **confidentiality** (keeping secrets), **integrity** (keeping data accurate), and **availability** (keeping systems working) of information. It involves protecting networks, devices, people, and data from unauthorized access or criminal exploitation.

Cloud Security

The process of making sure that digital assets stored in the **cloud** are properly configured (set up correctly) and that access to those assets is restricted strictly to authorized users.

Internal Threat

A security risk that comes from **inside the organization**. This can be a current or former employee, an external vendor, or a trusted partner.

Network Security

The practice of keeping an organization's **network infrastructure** (the connected systems, routers, and cables) secure from unauthorized access.

Personally Identifiable Information (PII)

Any basic information that can be used to **distinguish or infer an individual's identity**. Examples include your full name, home address, or email address.

Security Posture

An organization's overall **ability to manage its defense** of critical assets and data, and how effectively it can react to digital changes or attacks.

Sensitive Personally Identifiable Information (SPII)

A specific, **high-risk type of PII** that falls under much stricter legal handling guidelines. If stolen, it could cause severe harm or identity theft. Examples include Social Security Numbers (SSNs), medical records, and bank account details.

Technical Skills

Job-specific skills that require **knowledge of specialized tools, procedures, and policies** (like knowing how to code or use security software).

Threat

Any circumstance or event that has the potential to **negatively impact or harm** an organization's digital assets.

Threat Actor

Any **person or group** who presents a security risk or carries out a malicious attack against computers, networks, and data.

Transferable Skills

General abilities gathered from **other areas of study or life practice** (like communication or time management) that can apply successfully to different careers, including cybersecurity.